10 THINGS PAONIA SHOULD KNOW ABOUT ITS TOWN ADMINISTRATOR

Stefen Wynn, MPA, ICMA-CM — All facts from public records

---

1 He was fired unanimously from his last job.
Neptune Beach, Florida fired Wynn by unanimous City Council vote in January 2023 for **"flagrant neglect of duty"** and **"willful misconduct which substantially impairs or damages the interests or reputation of the city."** Paonia hired him six months later.
News 12 / WJCT News, Jacksonville.com — Jan 2023

2 He was accused of bullying employees and creating a toxic workplace.
Neptune Beach council members accused Wynn of bullying staff, using profanity toward employees, and storming out of offices during meetings. He also turned off public comments on the city's official Facebook page.
WJCT News / Action News Jax — Sep 2022 – Feb 2023

3 He controls all the money — alone.
Wynn consolidated Town Administrator and Town Treasurer into one role. He prepares the budget that determines his own salary. $106K in admin costs are allocated across enterprise funds — spread across four separate budget pages. The last time Paonia concentrated financial authority in one person, $480,000 was embezzled over five years (2007–2012).
Town of Paonia FY2025 & FY2026 Adopted Budgets

4 The town's savings are disappearing.
The FY2026 adopted budget projects fund balances dropping 23% in a single year ($5.4M → $4.1M). The Sales Tax CIP fund is projected to drop from $513K to $447K. Bridge Reserve projected down 73.5%. Meanwhile, new patrol cars, a street sweeper, and trucks keep coming.
Town of Paonia FY2025 & FY2026 Adopted Budgets

5 69% of the budget is grants and loans. If they stop, Paonia collapses.
The FY2026 adopted budget is $16.16M — but only ~$4.6M is the town's own revenue. The rest is grants and loans. Wynn took on a $9.74M water infrastructure loan adding $263K/year in debt payments through 2045. As of the FY2026 budget adoption, waterline replacement projects were still being carried over from the prior year.
Town of Paonia FY2026 Adopted Budget, High Country Spotlight — Mar 2025

6 He grew the bureaucracy 6x faster than the population.
Staff went from 19 to 25.7 FTE (+35%) with a 57% increase in admin positions. Population grew 1.1% during the same period. Personnel costs rose over $530K (+28%).
Town of Paonia FY2024–FY2026 Adopted Budget, Tri-City Courier

7 Surveillance cameras in Town Park — pointed at where your family gathers.
$50K+ on Verkada cloud cameras — a company fined $2.95M by the FTC. Cameras installed in Town Park, where families gather for summer festivals. All footage stored in the cloud. Without a court-issued warrant or order, access to this footage is suspect in today's climate. Board approved unanimously, zero public comment. No surveillance policy exists. Would a majority of Paonia consent to this?
Town of Paonia BOT minutes (Aug 12, 2025), FTC.gov

8 Century-old trees dying. $0 in the budget. Volunteers told to pound sand.
Historic drought. Tree Board volunteers resigned, ignored, or surveilled — their own liaison called himself "the town's spy." Public Works won't even meet with them. But there's $50K for cameras and new trucks for the fleet.
Delta County Independent — [illegible] Paonia FY2026 Budget

9 This isn't governing — it's shopping.
$1M backup generators. $500K cellular meters. $250K squad cars. $50K surveillance cameras. $43K trash cans. $33K sidewalk robots. Street sweeper requested. And only $35K for our streets, and $0 for the trees.
Town of Paonia FY2024–FY2026 Adopted Budgets

10 *Same pattern from Florida: anyone who asks questions gets pushed out.*
Trustee Brunner filed CORA requests and questioned a water tap sale — three months into his elected term. Wynn strong-armed the Board: remove him or I resign. They expelled Brunner. Wynn stayed. A hired administrator used his job as leverage to remove an elected official.
KVNF High Country Spotlight, Oct — Nov 2021

This is a public servant?
Ask your Trustees why he still has a job.

All facts sourced from adopted Town budgets, quarterly reports, court filings, and published news coverage.
Want everything yourself. File a CORA request: Town of Paonia, 214 Grand Ave, Paonia CO 81428.